

IN THE COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS

In re:

2026 MIT Mystery Hunt

Team: Setec Astronomy

**DECLARATION OF ROGER ALLAN FORD
CONCERNING “HEALTH & WELLNESS: TOUCH GRASS”**

I, Roger Allan Ford, declare:

1. I am a member of the MIT Mystery Hunt team Setec Astronomy, which is a team participating in the 2026 MIT Mystery Hunt.

2. The research task “Health & Wellness: Touch Grass” instructs teams to “[s]ubmit evidence of team member(s) touching grass.”

3. I declare under penalty of perjury that I have, since the start of the 2026 MIT Mystery Hunt, touched grass.

4. Specifically, earlier this evening, while walking to MIT Building W18 to take a photograph of the Edward and Joyce Linde Music Building, the newest building on MIT’s campus, I walked across some grass, thus indirectly touching it with my feet.

5. It is a well-established doctrine of law that indirect touching, such as through clothing or shoes, constitutes touching. For instance, in the classic tort case, *Vosburg v. Putney*, 80 Wis. 523, 50 N.W. 403 (1891), the court held that when the defendant lightly touched the plaintiff’s leg, through clothing, this constituted battery because it was an intentional, unpermitted touching, regardless of how slight or indirect. *Vosberg* is routinely cited in legal texts for the proposition that contact need not be skin-to-skin, but may be indirect.

6. In the course of so walking to Building W18, albeit not while I was personally walking on grass, I saw a bunny rabbit in front of Kresge Auditorium. As corroborating evidence of my trip, a true and correct photograph I took of said bunny rabbit earlier today is attached to this Declaration as Exhibit A.

7. As an attorney licensed to practice law by the Commonwealth of Massachusetts and the District of Columbia, I am well positioned to declare that this written declaration, signed under penalty of perjury pursuant to 28 U.S.C. § 1746, constitutes “evidence of team member(s) touching grass.”

I declare, under penalty of perjury, that the foregoing testimony is true and correct.

Respectfully submitted,

January 17, 2026

/s/ Roger Allan Ford
Roger Allan Ford
Member, Setec Astronomy

EXHIBIT A

